

Research Proposal

Course: Technical and Business Writing (TBW)

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Title: Mental Health Support App Prototype for Students using Figma

1. Introduction & Literature Review

Mental health issues such as stress, anxiety, and depression are increasingly common among university students due to academic pressure and lifestyle challenges. Many students avoid seeking help because of stigma or limited access to counseling services.

Digital applications provide an accessible way to support mental well-being. Research in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) shows that user-friendly and empathetic designs improve engagement and usability. Tools like Figma enable rapid prototyping and testing of such applications.

This research aims to design a mental health support application for students, focusing on simplicity, accessibility, and user engagement.

Problem Statement: Existing mental health apps often lack simplicity and student-focused features, leading to low engagement. This research asks: *How can a mental health support application be designed using Figma to improve usability and accessibility for students?*

Research Objectives:

1. Identify key mental health needs of students.
2. Design a low-fidelity wireframe.
3. Develop a high-fidelity interactive prototype.
4. Evaluate usability through user feedback.

2. Proposed Methodology

- **User Research:** Surveys/interviews with 5–10 students to identify needs.
- **Design Tool:** Figma for UI/UX design and prototyping.
- **Wireframing:** Create low-fidelity layouts for core screens.
- **Prototype:** Develop a high-fidelity interactive design.
- **Key Features:** Mood tracking, journaling, resources, relaxation tools, and emergency contacts.
- **Usability Testing:** 3–5 users perform tasks; feedback collected on usability and clarity.
- **Hardware Requirements:** None (UI/UX design only).

Final Deliverables: Interactive Figma prototype and a report with screenshots and evaluation.

3. Expected Results

The project will produce an interactive prototype with:

- Login/Signup Screen
- Dashboard Screen
- Mood Tracking Screen
- Journal Screen
- Resources Screen
- Emergency Support Screen

The system will simulate user interaction without backend integration.

4. Conclusions & Contributions

This research will provide a user-centered prototype for a student-focused mental health application. It highlights the role of effective UI/UX design in improving accessibility and engagement. The prototype can serve as a foundation for future development of a complete digital health system.